

Chapter-9

The Adjective

Read the following sentences and observe what the words in bold blue tell about a noun or a pronoun.

1. Ram is an **intelligent** boy. (describes the quality of boy)
2. She is **beautiful**. (describes the quality 'she')
3. This is my **new** car (describes the state of the car)
4. This is a **nice** book. (describes opinion about the book)
5. I have a **rectangular** table. (describes shape of the table)
6. I saw a **black** horse. (describes colour of the horse)
7. They have bought a **big** house. (describes size of the house)
8. Robert is an **American**. (describes nationality)
9. My father is **old**. (describes age of father)
10. I have **ten** pens. (describes number of pens)
11. Give me **some** rice. (describes quantity of rice)

You can observe that the words in bold blue font in the above sentences describe the quality, opinion, state, age, colour, shape, size, number, quantity, material or nationality of the nouns or the pronouns in the given sentences. These words that are used for people or things are called adjectives. Thus,

Definition: An adjective is a word that describes or explains a noun or a pronoun.

Exercise: Underline the nouns or pronouns and circle the adjectives in the following sentences:

1. Rohit is happy today.
2. Solomon was a wise king.
3. They have a huge mansion.
4. The students were quiet.
5. This question is easy.
6. Delhi is a crowded city.
7. Gold is a precious metal.
8. Her elder brother is fat.
9. This is a golden opportunity for me.
10. Mr. Keshav is a wonderful person.

Order of Adjectives

Sometimes, we may need to use more than one adjective to describe a person or a thing. In such a situation, the following order of adjectives should be followed.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
Quantity or Number	Quality or opinion	size	physical quality	age	shape	colour	Proper Adjective/ Origin	Material	Purpose	Noun
a	beautiful	-	-	new	round	brown	Chinese	wooden	wall	clock
one	royal	small	well-maintained	antique	-	black	American	-	racing	car
-	-	small	strong	latest	oval	white	German	plastic	hand	blender
some	ethnic	-	-	new	-	red	Indian	Silk	party	dresses

Exercise: Put the adjectives used in the following sentences in correct order.

1. My father bought me a black, leather, new, beautiful, jacket.

2. She is a Chinese, middle-aged, short lady.

3. My uncle gifted me a steel, Titan, golden, latest watch.

4. She sang a welcome, melodious, old song.

5. John has a office, cotton, worn-out, white, shirt.

Kinds of Adjectives

Kinds of Adjectives	Examples
1. Adjectives of Quality	tall, good, new, happy, oval, Indian, big, red, torn etc.
2. Adjectives of Number	one, two, tenth, some, many, more, most few, a few, the few, fewer, several, all, both, any etc.
3. Adjectives of Quantity	some, much, more, most, little, a little, the little, less, whole, half, no, any etc.
4. Possessive Adjectives	my, our, his, her, your, their, its
5. Demonstrative Adjectives	this, that, these, those, such etc.
6. Interrogative Adjectives	what, which, whose
7. Distributive Adjectives	each, every, either, neither
8. Emphasizing Adjectives	very, own
9. Exclamatory Adjectives	what

Adjectives of Quality

Adjectives of quality describe the kind, quality or characteristics of a noun or a pronoun. These adjectives describe size, colour, shape, state, age, opinion, material etc. of a noun or a pronoun.

Examples: Red bangles, circular motion, huge ship, old memories, interesting story, common name, silver lining, etc.

Proper Adjectives: Adjectives which are formed from proper nouns are called proper adjectives.

Examples: Indian Flag, Chinese toys, British Airways, American author etc.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with adjectives of quality.

1. Riya is a.....singer.
2. My mother wore asaree for the party.
3. Charlie Chaplin was aman.
4. Look! There is acoin.
5. Milk keeps the bone.....
6. I likebananas.
7. He belongs to afamily.
8. She has acar.
9. Kolkata is a city.
10. The baby has.....cheeks.

Adjectives of Number

An adjective of number, as the name suggests, describes the number of a noun or a pronoun. It answers the question, 'how many'. It is used for countable nouns or pronouns.

There are two types of adjectives of number.

(i) Definite Numeral Adjectives: Definite numeral adjectives indicate the exact number of a noun or a pronoun.

Example: **Two** boys are playing in the park.

There are two types of definite numeral adjectives.

(a) Cardinals: Cardinals denote the exact number of a noun or a pronoun.

Example: There are **five** boys in this row.

(b) Ordinals: Ordinals denote the order or rank of a noun or a pronoun. Examples: first, second, third, tenth, last, next etc. Article 'the' or a possessive determiner is used before an ordinal.

Example: The **fifth** boy in this row is my friend.

(ii) Indefinite Numeral Adjectives: Indefinite numeral adjective doesn't indicate the exact number of the noun or pronoun it refers to.

Example: **Several** people are waiting in the queue.

There are **many** birds on this tree.

Adjectives of Quantity

An adjective of quantity indicates the quantity of a noun or a pronoun. It answers the question, 'how much'. It is used for uncountable nouns or pronouns.

Examples: some, any, no, much, little, half, all, whole, sufficient, enough, great, etc.

1. I ate **some** rice.
2. There is not **much** oil in the bottle.
3. I don't have **any** money.
4. This statement makes **no** sense.
5. There is **sufficient** milk in the jug.
6. I don't have **enough** time to waste on these matters.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with adjectives of number or adjectives of quantity.

1. I have.....fingers and.....toes.
2. The heart has.....chambers.
3. Sh. Lal Bahdur Shastri was the Prime Minister of India.
4. It is myday to my new school, so I am nervous.
5. He has lost.....his wealth
6. There arestudents in our class.
7. We get our recess period after the..... period.
8. Please give me.....sugar.
9. This money is not.....to buy a new car.
10. He losthis wealth in gambling.

Possessive Adjectives

The words 'my', 'our', 'your', 'his', 'her', 'its' and 'their' are used as possessive adjectives.

- Examples:**
1. India is **our** country.
 2. You must complete **your** work.
 3. It is **her** notebook.
 4. The dog wagged **its** tail.

Possessive Pronouns and Possessive Adjectives

Both possessive pronouns and possessive adjectives are used to show possession or belonging. However, whereas pronouns replace the nouns, adjectives describe the nouns. Possessive adjectives are placed before nouns. **Examples:**

Possessive Pronoun	Possessive Adjective
This book is mine .	This is my book.
That house is yours .	That is your house.
These bags are theirs	These are their bags.
This pencil is hers .	This is her pencil.

Important Note: Don't use any apostrophe (') with possessive adjectives. The only exception is the pronoun 'one' which takes an apostrophe (') to make its possessive adjective. Example: One must do one's duty.

Demonstrative Adjectives

The words 'this', 'that', 'these', 'those' and 'such' are called demonstratives as they are used to point out to persons or things they refer to.

Look at the use of demonstrative Adjectives in the following sentences.

1. **This** pencil is mine. (Used for singular thing which is near the speaker)
2. **That** car is new. (Used for singular thing which is at a distance from the speaker)
3. **These** kites are mine. (Used for plural things which are near the speaker)
4. **Those** oranges are fresh. (Used for plural things which are at a distance from the speaker)
5. I don't like **such** people.

Demonstrative Pronouns and Demonstrative Adjectives

Both demonstrative pronouns and demonstrative adjectives are used to point out a noun or a pronoun they refer to. However, whereas pronouns replace the nouns, adjectives describe the nouns. Examples:

Demonstrative Pronoun	Demonstrative Adjective
This is my book.	This book is mine.
That is your house.	That house is yours.
These are their bags.	These bags are theirs.
This is her pencil.	This pencil is hers.

Interrogative Adjectives

The words 'what', 'which' and 'whose' are interrogative pronouns used to ask questions about persons or things. These words can be used as interrogative adjectives too. When used just before a noun, these words become interrogative adjectives.

Interrogative Pronoun	Interrogative Adjective
Which of these is your book?	Which book is yours?
What is the news he broke to you?	What news did he break to you?
Whose is this house?	Whose house is this?

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with interrogative adjectives.

1.nonsense is this?
2.book is yours?
3.book is this?
4. colour do you like the most?
5.flavour of ice-cream would you like to eat?
6.child is this crying in the street?

Distributive Adjectives

The adjectives that refer to a single person or thing in a group, one at a time, are called distributive adjectives. 'each', 'every', 'either', 'neither' are called distributive adjectives. Nouns preceded by distributive adjectives always take a singular verb.

Each and Every

'Each' and 'every' are similar in meaning, but there is a difference between the two. Each is used when speaking of two or more persons or things. 'Every' is used when speaking of more than two persons or things. Each directs attention to every person or thing of a group individually and separately. 'Every' is comprehensive, considering all; it directs attention to the whole group without any exception. Each is used to denote a person or thing out of a known or limited group. 'Every' is used in a wide sense to denote persons or things when the number is unlimited.

- Examples:**
1. **Each** child was given a sweet. (considering each individual out of a limited group)
 2. **Every** child likes sweets. (considering all in an unlimited group)

Either and Neither

'Either' has two meanings: (i) One out of two (ii) Each of two
'Neither' means None out of two.

- Examples:**
1. There are trees on **either** side of the road. (each out of two)
 2. **Neither** side of the road has trees. (None out of two)

Distributive Pronouns and Distributive Adjectives

Distributive Pronoun	Distributive Adjective
1. Each of the students was given a prize.	1. Each student was given a prize.
2. Either of the two boys had completed his work.	2. Either boy completed his work.
3. Neither of the sides of road has trees.	3. Neither side of the road has trees.

Emphasizing Adjectives

Emphasizing adjectives lay stress on a particular person or thing.

Examples:

1. His **very** name makes me smile.
2. He is making a pot with his **own** hands.

Exclamatory Adjectives

Exclamatory adjectives are used before nouns in an exclamatory sentence.

Examples:

1. **What** a beautiful house!
2. **What** good luck!

Formation of Adjectives

- Some words are independent adjectives. They are not formed from any other part of speech.
Examples: rich, hot, yellow, thin etc.
- Some Adjectives are formed from verbs by adding the suffix ‘-ing’. These adjectives are called present participle.
Examples: a moving train, a dancing doll, a burning house etc.
- Sometimes the third form of the verb is used as adjective. This is called past participle.
Examples: a locked house, a broken ship, a chained elephant etc.
- Most adjectives are formed from nouns, verbs and adjectives by adding suffixes. A few examples are given below.

Root Word	Suffix	Adjective	Root Word	Suffix	Adjective
accident	-al	accidental	age	-d	aged
ceremony	-ial	ceremonial	gift	-ed	gifted
enjoy	-able	enjoyable	east	-ern	eastern
abound	-ant	abundant	gold	-en	golden
clerk	-ical	clerical	charm	-ing	charming
sense	-ible	sensible	affection	-ate	affectionate
abuse	-ive	abusive	child	-like	childlike
air	-y	airy	burden	-some	burdensome
compliment	-ary	complimentary	trust	-worthy	trustworthy
brother	-ly	brotherly	help	-less	helpless

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with adjectives formed from the words given in the brackets.

- The traffic here is very.....for children. (danger)
- This child is.....(health)
- This book has a greatvalue. (history)
- Mr. George is an.....politician. (America)
- After thetsunami, a new danger threatened Japan. (mass)
- I was.....with my friend. (anger)
- This building is really.....(impression)
- The Taj Mahal is with gardens. (surrounding)
- Sarojini Naidu played anrole in India’s freedom struggle. (importance)
- Last night I read an awfully.....story. (fun)

Degrees of Adjectives

There are three degrees of adjectives.

(i) Positive Degree: A positive degree of adjective is used when the adjective describes only one thing or person without making any comparison. Even if there is any comparison involved, it is between one and none.

Examples: Ram is a **tall** boy. (Describing only Ram)

No boy in the class is as **tall** as Ram.(Comparison between one and non)

(ii) Comparative Degree: A comparative degree of adjective is used when the adjective compares two persons, things or groups. Here, the mode of comparison is 'one to one'. The comparative degree is followed by the conjunction 'than'. The comparison may be made in three ways.

- (a) Individual compared with individual **Example:** Ram is **taller** than Shyam.
 - (b) Individual compared with a group **Example:** Ram is **taller** than any other boy in the class.
 - (c) Group compared with a group **Example:** The players of team A are **taller** than the players of team B.
- (iii) Superlative Degree:** A superlative degree of adjective is used when one person or thing is compared with all others in the group. Here the mode of comparison is 'one to all' **Example:** Ram is the **tallest** boy in the class.

Formation of Comparative and Superlative Degrees

1. Most of adjectives form their comparative and superlative degrees by adding the suffixes ‘-er’ and ‘-est’ respectively. The table given below contains a list of such adjectives. Practise degrees of the adjectives and complete the table.

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
bright	brighter	brightest
bold	bolder	bolders
high	higher	highest
	quieter	
		cleverest
near		
	cleaner	
dear		
		deepest
few		
	faster	
		greatest
hard		
	keener	
		lightest
weak		
	poorer	
		richest
sweet		
	shorter	
		strongest
tall		
	smaller	
		slowest

2. Some adjectives end with an ‘e’. These adjectives form their comparative and superlative degrees by adding the suffixes ‘-r’ and ‘st’ respectively. The table given below contains a list of such adjectives. Practise degrees of the adjectives and complete the table.

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
able	abler	ablest
simple	simpler	simplest
noble		
		wisest
close		
	truer	
		rarest
dense		
	wider	
		largest
rude		

3. Some adjectives have only one syllable, ending with a consonant preceded by a vowel. For example: ‘red’. Such adjectives form their comparative and superlative degrees by doubling the consonant and adding the suffixes ‘-er’ and ‘est’ respectively. The table given below contains a list of such adjectives. Practise degrees of the adjectives and complete the table.

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
red	redder	reddest
hot	hotter	hottest
fat		
thin		
mad		
sad		
big		

5. Some adjectives end with ‘y’. Such adjectives form their comparative and superlative degrees by removing ‘y’ and adding the suffixes ‘-ier’ and ‘-iest’ respectively. The table given below contains a list of such adjectives. Practise degrees of the adjectives and complete the table.

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
happy	happier	happiest
tiny	tinier	tiniest
heavy	heavier	heaviest
busy		
noisy		
creepy		

6. Some adjectives are long words and have more than two syllables. Such adjectives form their comparative and superlative degrees by adding the words 'more' and 'most' respectively. Practise degrees of the adjectives and complete the table.

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
beautiful	more beautiful	most beautiful
intelligent	more intelligent	most intelligent
important		
careful		
diligent		
ignorant		
capable		
interesting		
wonderful		
difficult		

7. Some adjectives have irregular comparative and superlative degrees.

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
good	better	best
well	better	best
bad	worse	worst
late	later/latter	latest/last
little	less	least
much	more	most
many	more	most
far	farther	farthest
far	further	furthest

8. Some adjectives don't have their comparative or superlative degree.

Examples: perfect, complete, absolute, whole, square, round, eternal, universal, unique etc.

9. The comparative degree is generally followed by 'than', but comparatives ending in '-er' and '-or' are followed by the preposition 'to'.

Examples:

1. Harish is inferior to Ramesh in designation.
2. My brother is elder to me.
3. She is junior to all her colleagues.
4. The Quit India Movement happened prior to Gandhi ji's death.

10. Use of double comparative degree or double superlative degree is wrong.

Examples:

1. He is more wiser than I am. (Incorrect)
He is wiser than I am. (Correct)
2. He is the most tallest boy in the class. (Incorrect)
He is the tallest boy in the class. (Correct)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with the correct degree of adjectives given in the bracket.

1. Siya is the (beautiful) girl in the class.
2. This tree is.....than that. (tall).
3. He isnow. (good)
4. John is as.....as his brother. (intelligent)
5. This is the.....(interesting) book I have ever read.
6. Dimple is.....than her sister. (young)
7. Oil is(light) than milk.
8. Everest is the.....mountain peak. (high)
9. I am.....interested in your story. (little)
10. His condition has become the.....now. (bad)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with the correct word.

1. My brother is elder(than/to) me.
2. Amazon is the(larger/largest) of all rivers.
3. Which is the(best/better) of the two?
4. No.....(fewer/ less) than fifty persons were killed in the accident.
5. Both of you make..... (the most perfect/a perfect) couple.
6. My(elder/older) brother is looking for a new job.
7. The(more/most) you practise, the better your game will be.
8. He is(the most unique/a unique) person.
9. Mr. Sharma is senior.....(to/than) me.
10. My(elder/older) brother is a doctor.

Exercise: Write the antonyms of the following adjectives. Remember the antonyms should also be adjectives.

Adjective	Antonym (Adjective)	Adjective	Antonym (Adjective)
cold		fast	
tall		ancient	
long		early	
big		old	
near		beautiful	
fat		wise	
wide		closed	
dark		heavy	

Verbs Used as Adjectives

The present participle form and the past participle form of the verb can also be used as an adjective. These are called verbal adjectives.

Examples:

1. I have a **dancing** doll.
2. The movie was **interesting**.
3. We found the house **locked**.
4. The **lost** child was crying bitterly.

In the examples give above, the verbs 'dancing' and 'interesting' are the present participle forms of the verbs describing the nouns 'doll' and 'movie' respectively. Similarly, the verbs 'locked' and 'lost' are the past participle forms of the verbs describing the nouns 'house' and 'child' respectively.

Exercise: Underline the verbal adjectives in the following sentences. State whether it is present participle or past participle.

1. My new job is very interesting.
2. I like the sound of jingling bells.
3. The shooting star looks beautiful.
4. Barking dogs seldom bite.
5. Broken toys were lying around everywhere.
6. John looked frightened by the noise.
7. I was amazed to see her collection of postal tickets.
8. My mother found my result disappointing.
9. It was an amazing performance.

Use of Adjectives in Similes

A simile is a figure of speech often employed in poetry to make comparisons between persons, animals or objects. Adjectives are frequently used in similes.

Examples: as **busy** as bee, as **soft** as silk, as **easy** as A.B.C.

Exercise: Complete the similes given below by choosing adjectives given in the box.

brave, gentle, hot, faithful, heavy, happy, red, cold, green
crafty, free, round, good, black, deep, brittle, loud, deaf

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------------|
| 1. as..... as coal | 10. as..... as thunder |
| 2. as as glass | 11. as..... as a post |
| 3. as..... as ice | 12. as..... as a lion |
| 4 as..... as gold | 13. as..... as air |
| 5. as..... as grass | 14 as..... as a ball |
| 6. as..... as a king | 15. as..... as fire |
| 7. as..... as a lamb | 16. as..... as a well |
| 8. as..... as blood | 17. as..... as crow |
| 9. as..... as lead | 18. as..... as dog |

Transformation of Sentences by using Degrees of Adjectives

Read the following three sentences carefully and observe the way of transformation.

1. No boy in the class is as **intelligent** as Ram.
2. Ram is **more intelligent than** any other boy in the class.
3. Ram is **the most intelligent** boy in the class.

The meaning of all the three sentences written above is the same. In all of them, it is Ram who is the most intelligent boy. He is the only boy who is the most intelligent. However, this sense is conveyed by using Positive, Comparative and Superlative Degrees of the Adjectives.

Read the following three sentences carefully and observe the way of transformation.

1. Few boys in the class are as **intelligent** as Ram.
2. Ram is **more intelligent than** most other boys in the class.
3. Ram is one of **the most intelligent** boys in the class.

The meaning of all the three sentences written above is the same. In all of them, Ram is one of the most intelligent boys in the class. He is not the only boy who is the most intelligent. However, this sense is conveyed by using Positive, Comparative and Superlative Degree of the Adjectives.

Read the following sentences carefully and observe the way of transformation.

1. Ram is not the tallest of all the boys in the class.
2. Ram is not taller than some other boys in the class.
3. Some other boys in the class are at least as tall as Ram.

Read the following sentence carefully.

Ritika is not as **beautiful** as Rashmi.

In this sentence, there is a comparison between two people. The same sentence can be rewritten without changing the sense in the following way.

Rashmi is **more beautiful** than Ritika.

Read the following sentence carefully.

Abdul is as **strong** as his brother.

In this sentence, there is a comparison between two people. The same sentence can be rewritten without changing the sense in the following way.

Abdul's brother is not **stronger** than he is.

Exercise: Transform the following sentences by changing the degrees of adjectives without changing the meaning of the sentences.

1. Some boys are at least as industrious as Kunal.

.....
.....

2. Soloman was the wisest king.

.....
.....

3. This is the hottest place in this region.

.....
.....

4. I am as strong as he is.

.....
.....

5. Some girls are at least as beautiful as Mona.

.....
.....

6. His father is smarter than he is.

.....

7. Reema is not as sweet as her sister.

.....

8. Bombay is one of the richest towns in India.

.....

.....

9. Nisha is not one of the cleverest girls of the class.

.....

.....

10. Your house is not more spacious than mine.

.....

11. A rabbit is more social than a hare.

.....

12. Alligators are not as aggressive as crocodiles.

.....

13. Siachen Glacier is the longest mountain glacier in India.

.....

.....

14. My bag is heavier than your bag.

.....

15. Amitabh Bachchan is the most popular actor in India

.....

.....

Exercise: The following passage has not been edited. There is an error in each line for which a space has been provided. Underline the incorrect word in the line and write the correct word in the space provided.

Cricket grew out of much stick-and-ball games

.....

playing in England 500 years ago. The word bat is

.....

an olden English word that simply means stick or

.....

club. By the seventeen century, cricket had evolved

.....

enoughly to be recognised as a distinct game.

.....

A test match can go for fifth days and still end in a

.....

draw. Cricket grounds can be oval or circle. Cricket

.....

was the earlier modern team sport to be codified.

.....

The one written 'Laws of Cricket' were drawn up in 1744.

.....